



Start-ups from concept to launch

A new business can be described as a start-up in the early phases of its launch, when an entrepreneur comes up with the idea for a product or service, and develops the concept into something that will sell.

How it works

The idea is just the start. Next comes the process of expanding the concept into a viable business. Specialized help may be needed in some areas—hiring a website and logo designer, for example, and an accountant to advise on the best structure and financial setup. What the business and product or service are called can make or

break the start-up, so it is worth spending some time doing online research to make sure no one else is using an intended name, especially in a negative context. Location is another consideration with significant cost implications. It may be possible to create a virtual office and work from home. Finding premises is an extra stage, but the goal at start-up is to keep costs low.



NEED TO KNOW

- **Lean start-up** Method of learning fast and discarding what does not work to keep start-up costs down
- **Start-up pivot** Quickly changing direction or correcting mistakes based on customer feedback or technology changes

START



Come up with a good idea

Develop a product, or an idea for a product.



Register IP

For an invention or innovation, register your intellectual property (IP).



Set up an online presence

Register the domain name and set up web hosting.



Decide on a name

Check to determine whether your proposed name is available; check that the domain name is available; search online for competitors with similar names.



Create a look

Design a logo and visual identity for the business.

Make a website

Build a website. Research search engine optimization (SEO) words to use on it (see pp.230–231).

